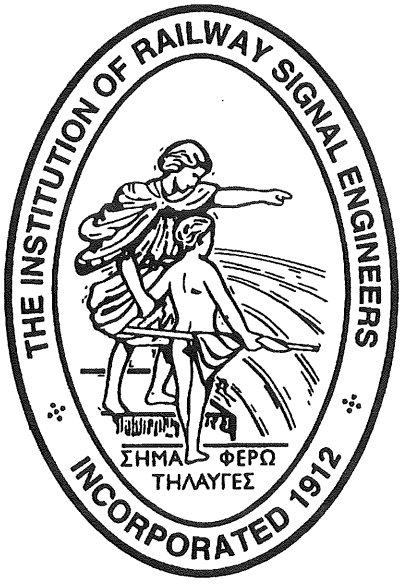
INTRODUCTION TO SIGNALLING

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INTRODUCTION



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Books and magazines on railway subjects have mushroomed over the past twenty years. Hardly a day goes by without a new publication being available on the bookstalls. One would think that every possible railway subject is covered many times over within all these words but strangely, signalling subjects feature only rarely. A person seeking information on signalling systems would be hard pushed to find detail on anything except the basic types of signals and aspects.

Signalling remains something of a mystery to most people claiming to have an interest in railways. Even those actively engaged in the profession, would not find a single publication that gives a description and technical detail of modern signalling equipment, systems and practice.

This book is, therefore, long overdue, but great care has been taken to ensure that the content is accurate and representative of current practice. The systems have all evolved over many generations of signalling engineers and those of you with access to older publications will see how the development process has worked. All the systems described can be found in the United Kingdom and will be in service for many decades to come.

The book does not yet cover transmission based signalling in any great detail. Such systems are in use on the new high-speed lines of Europe and will be introduced into the UK over the next decade. An additional set of chapters will be necessary to cover this technology and the make up of the book will allow this to happen.

The book is intended for those young persons who are setting out on a railway career and who will be engaged in train operations as well as being budding signal engineers. Signalling is sometimes seen as a 'cottage industry' or even a 'black art'. This is unfortunate and the book will help to dispel this myth. The book will have wide appeal and should be of value to all persons with an interest in railways.

The book is put together in single sided format so that students can make their own notes on the blank opposite pages. It is loose-leaf in order that revised pages or reprinted chapters can easily be inserted. This will enable the book to be kept up to date – we do not wish to wait thirty years or so for the next one!

Technical terms and words that might be new to the reader are emphasised by being printed in *italics*.

Readers who wish for more information on the various subjects may consider acquisition of the relevant Institution of Railway Signal Engineers (IRSE) 'Green Booklet', now reprinted in modern format and available from the IRSE London Office. Additionally, readers may wish to consult the IRSE Professional Examination reading list which broadly refers to the most significant papers which have been given at the London meetings over the past few years. Again, these are available from the London Office but assistance can also be obtained from the Institution's Training and Development Manager.

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